

NORTH INDIAN ORIGIN

# Laccha Paratha

Multi-Layered Flaky Flatbread

The Dhaba Bread with a Hundred Layers

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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## Laccha Paratha

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

# Laccha Paratha

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.



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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

# Bread Engineered for Flakiness

Laccha paratha takes its name from the Hindi word "lachha," referring to the strand-like, layered pattern visible when you tear the bread open — dozens of thin, flaky layers achieved through a folding and coiling technique rather than any special ingredient. It's a bread built almost entirely on technique, a showcase of the North Indian tava cook's skill with dough.

The method — brushing rolled dough with ghee, then folding it into pleats or rolling it into a tight coil before flattening and cooking — is thought to have developed within North Indian and Punjabi tava-bread traditions as cooks experimented with ways to make a richer, more textured alternative to plain paratha. However it began, it became a fixture of North Indian dhabas and restaurants, prized for the way its crisp, flaky layers contrast against rich, creamy gravies.

Today, laccha paratha is a menu staple wherever North Indian food is served, from roadside dhabas to fine dining restaurants abroad, and its dramatic layered structure has made it something of a visual signature — the bread photographs as beautifully as it eats.



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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

# Bread Engineered for Flakiness, continued

### CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A North Indian and Punjabi dhaba staple, valued as much for its flaky texture as its rich flavor. A visually striking bread, often specifically requested for its distinctive layered appearance. Frequently paired with rich, creamy gravies like butter chicken and paneer makhani, where its crisp layers provide textural contrast. Considered a more indulgent, technique-driven alternative to everyday roti.



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AT A GLANCE

# Equipment & preparation

| 20m | 30m | 20m | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| ACTIVE PREP | DOUGH REST | COOK TIME | SERVINGS (5 PARATHAS) |

**Med**

DIFFICULTY

## Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowl
- Rolling pin
- Heavy tava or cast-iron skillet
- Basting brush for ghee
- A clean work surface for folding and coiling

### STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Dough can be refrigerated after resting for up to a day. Cooked laccha paratha is best fresh and warm, when the layers are at their crispest, but keeps at room temperature for a few hours or refrigerated for 2 days — reheat on a dry hot tava to help restore some crispness.



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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

# Ingredients

## For the dough

| INGREDIENT | US | METRIC | INDIAN |
|---|---|---|---|
| All-purpose flour (maida) | 2 cups | 250 g | 2 katori |
| Water, warm | ¾ cup approx. | 180 ml approx. | ¾ katori approx. |
| Salt | ½ tsp | 3 g | to taste |
| Sugar | ¼ tsp | 1 g | ¼ chammach |
| Oil, for the dough | 1 tbsp | 15 ml | 1 chammach |
| Ghee, for layering and cooking | 4 tbsp | 60 g | 4 chammach |
| Dry flour, for dusting during layering | 2 tbsp | 15 g | 2 tbsp |

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

All-purpose flour gives the classic flaky texture; a portion can be swapped for whole wheat flour for a heartier version, though the layers will be slightly less delicate. Ghee is strongly preferred over oil for the layering step, as its flavor and higher smoke point are what give laccha paratha its signature richness and crisp layers — this is one recipe where the substitution genuinely changes the result.



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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

# Making the Dough

## 01 MIX AND KNEAD

Combine flour, salt, and sugar in a bowl. Add the oil and gradually mix in warm water, kneading for 8–10 minutes until you have a smooth, soft dough.

## 02 REST THE DOUGH

Cover with a damp cloth and rest for at least 30 minutes — this relaxes the gluten, making the dough much easier to roll thin for layering.





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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

# Making the Dough, continued

**COOKING CHECKPOINT**

The dough should feel soft, smooth, and easy to stretch without tearing or springing back sharply.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

# Layering & Cooking

## 03 ROLL THIN

Divide the dough into 5 balls. Roll each as thin as possible into a large round or oval, dusting lightly with dry flour as needed.

## 04 BRUSH AND LAYER

Brush the rolled dough generously with ghee and sprinkle lightly with dry flour. Fold into pleats, accordion-style, from one edge to the other — or alternatively, roll it into a tight coil, like a cinnamon roll.





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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

# Layering & Cooking, continued

## 05 COIL AND FLATTEN

If using the pleating method, gently stretch the pleated strip and coil it into a spiral, tucking the end underneath. Press down gently and rest for a few minutes, then roll out carefully into a round, about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick — try to preserve the layered structure rather than pressing it completely flat.

## 06 COOK UNTIL CRISP

Heat a tava until hot. Cook the paratha with a generous amount of ghee on both sides, pressing gently with a spatula, until golden brown and crisp, 2–3 minutes per side.

**Texture indicator.** a well-made laccha paratha should feel light and crisp on the outside, and when you press the edge gently, you should see the individual layers separate slightly.

## 07 CRUSH TO SEPARATE THE LAYERS

Immediately after cooking, gently crush the paratha between your palms — a classic dhaba move that separates and fluffs the layers, making them clearly visible when torn open.

**MISTAKE TO AVOID**

Rolling the coiled dough too aggressively flat, pressing hard with the rolling pin, crushes the layers before they even reach the tava. Roll gently and evenly, applying light, even pressure.



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SERVING & PAIRING

# How to serve



## Traditional Style

- Served hot and torn open to show the flaky layers, alongside rich gravies like butter chicken or dal makhani.

## Restaurant Presentation

- Served whole or in wedges, with the layered structure visible from a slight tear at the edge.



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SERVING & PAIRING

# How to serve, continued

## Family Style

- A shared basket at the table, often ordered alongside plain naan so guests can choose their preferred texture.

## Modern Pairing

- Works beautifully with simple yogurt and pickle for a lighter, texture-forward meal on its own.



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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

# Chef secrets

## Getting the Layers Right

- Ghee, not oil, between the layers is essential for both flavor and the crisp, flaky texture laccha paratha is known for.
- A light dusting of dry flour between folds helps prevent the layers from sticking together and fusing during cooking.

## Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Dough can be made a day ahead and refrigerated; even the coiled, unrolled portions can be frozen individually and rolled fresh from frozen.
- Crush the layers immediately after cooking, while still hot — this is much harder to do once the paratha has cooled and set.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some dhaba cooks use their hands to stretch the rolled dough slightly before coiling, creating even thinner, more numerous layers than rolling alone achieves.



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BONUS CONTENT

# Nutrition, variations & FAQ

## APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

| 240 kcal | 5 g | 34 g | 9 g | 1.5 g |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| CALORIES | PROTEIN | CARBOHYDRATES | FAT | FIBER |

Estimates only; actual values vary with fat used and portion size.

### ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

## REGIONAL VARIATIONS

| | |
|---|---|
| **Whole Wheat Laccha Paratha** | a heartier version using part or all whole wheat flour. |
| **Methi Laccha Paratha** | fresh fenugreek leaves worked into the dough for extra flavor. |
| **Stuffed Laccha Paratha** | a modern variation with a thin layer of spiced potato or paneer folded in before coiling. |

## Why aren't my layers visible?

Usually not enough ghee between folds, or rolling the coiled dough too flat and firmly. Use a generous ghee brush and roll gently.



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# Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

## Can I make this ahead of time?

The dough and even the coiled, unrolled portions freeze well — roll and cook fresh whenever you're ready to serve.

## Is laccha paratha the same as plain paratha?

No — plain paratha is a simpler folded or single-layer bread, while laccha paratha specifically uses the coiling technique to create many distinct, visible layers.



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REFERENCE

# Ingredient glossary





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REFERENCE

# Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

| | |
|---|---|
| **Lachha** | Hindi for strands or threads, describing the bread's visible layered structure. |
| **Ghee** | clarified butter, essential to achieving this bread's rich, flaky layers. |
| **Tava** | a flat griddle used for cooking most North Indian breads. |
| **Maida** | refined white flour, the base of this bread's dough. |



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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

# Laccha Paratha

| | |
|---|---|
| **20m** ACTIVE PREP | **30m** DOUGH REST |
| **20m** COOK TIME | **4** SERVINGS (5 PARATHAS) |
| **Med** DIFFICULTY | |

## DOUGH

| | |
|---|---|
| All-purpose flour | 250 g |
| Water | 180 ml approx. |
| Salt | 3 g |
| Sugar | 1 g |
| Oil | 15 ml |
| Ghee | 60 g |
| Dry flour | 15 g |

## METHOD

01 **Mix and knead.** Combine flour, salt, and sugar in a bowl.

02 **Rest the dough.** Cover with a damp cloth and rest for at least 30 minutes — this relaxes the gluten, making the dough much easier to roll thin for layering.

03 **Roll thin.** Divide the dough into 5 balls.

04 **Brush and layer.** Brush the rolled dough generously with ghee and sprinkle lightly with dry flour.

05 **Coil and flatten.** If using the pleating method, gently stretch the pleated strip and coil it into a spiral, tucking the end underneath.

06 **Cook until crisp.** Heat a tava until hot.

07 **Crush to separate the layers.** Immediately after cooking, gently crush the paratha between your palms — a classic dhaba move that separates and fluffs the layers, making them clearly visible when torn open.



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BEFORE YOU SHOP

# Shopping list

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ All-purpose flour | 250 g | ☐ Salt | 3 g |
| ☐ Sugar | 1 g | ☐ Oil | 15 ml |
| ☐ Ghee | 60 g | ☐ Dry flour | 15 g |



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